



Microcline

△ **Rough specimen** of amazonite

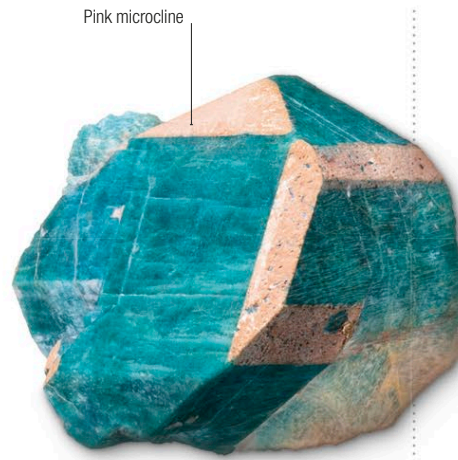
Microcline is one of the most common potassium aluminosilicate feldspar minerals; the other is orthoclase. Blue-green to green specimens of microcline are called amazonstone or amazonite. Although deep blue-green is the most sought-after colour, it varies from yellow-green to blue-green and may exhibit white streaks. Gem material is usually opaque and is cut *en cabochon*; it is rarely used for carvings or beads, being relatively brittle. Gem-quality amazonite is found in Minas Gerais in Brazil, Colorado in the US, and the Ural Mountains in Russia.

Specification

Chemical name Potassium aluminosilicate | **Formula** KAlSi_3O_8 | **Colours** White, pale yellow, green, blue-green
Structure Triclinic | **Hardness** 6–6.5 | **SG** 2.6
RI 1.52–1.53 | **Lustre** Vitreous | **Streak** White
Locations Russia, USA, Brazil



Microcline crystals | Rough | In this specimen, a cluster of light-coloured, blocky microcline crystals is set in a groundmass of rock.



Amazonite crystal | Rough | This superbly formed, blue-green rough amazonite crystal is intergrown with contrasting layers of pink microcline.

The name
“microcline”
 originates from
 the Greek for
“small slope”



Amazonite slice | Colour variety | The deep blue-green hue of this rough slice of amazonite is widely considered to be its most desirable colour for use in gemstones.



Cabochon | Colour variety | This polished cabochon of amazonite demonstrates the texture and fine turquoise colour of excellent, gem-quality material.

Crystal group | Rough | This group of three minerals shows the classic pegmatite assemblage – blue aquamarine and quartz perched on a microcline crystal.

